PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Vulnerability and Exposure Management | Security Monitoring | Incident Response | Microsoft Defender XDR

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience in security operations, vulnerability and exposure management, and incident response at enterprise scale. Holding the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification, I bring Tier 2 and Tier 3 Security Operations Centre (SOC) experience alongside deep hands-on capability across Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms. At the University of the Arts, London (UAL), I have led vulnerability management programmes from discovery through remediation using Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), and Nessus; monitored and investigated security events using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel; and managed major security incidents following the NIST 800-61 Computer Security Incident Handling Guide. I have strong experience securing both cloud and on-premises environments and apply frameworks including MITRE ATT&CK, Common Vulnerability Scoring System (CVSS), CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEV), and NIST to prioritise risk and drive technical decisions during investigations. I am now looking to apply this breadth of experience in a senior analyst role within a global organisation where I can work closely with a capable security team to strengthen detection, accelerate response, and reduce organisational risk.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Monitoring and SIEM:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM (expert), Microsoft Sentinel (strong), Kusto Query Language (KQL), alert triage, log analysis and investigation
- **Endpoint and Identity Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Defender XDR; Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Identity and Access Management (IAM) monitoring and hardening
- **Vulnerability and Exposure Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; CVSS scoring, CISA KEV catalogue, risk-based remediation prioritisation
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 Computer Security Incident Handling Guide, structured incident lifecycle (identification, containment, eradication, recovery), forensic documentation
- **SOC Operations:** Tier 2 and Tier 3 alert investigation, threat hunting, adversary TTP analysis, MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping
- **SOAR and Automation:** SOAR playbook development, automated triage workflows, PowerShell scripting
- **Cloud and On-Premises Security:** Microsoft Azure / Entra ID, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Privileged Access:** BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CVSS, CISA KEV, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead the vulnerability and exposure management programme across a 20,000-user environment, using Tenable.io, Pentera BAS, AppCheck, and Nessus to identify, prioritise, and drive remediation of critical and high-severity vulnerabilities using CVSS and CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEV)
- Monitor and investigate security events using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, performing Tier 3 analysis and making technical decisions on containment and escalation during active incidents
- Manage and continuously harden Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policies, and Identity and Access Management (IAM) configurations to reduce identity-based attack surface

- Oversee Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) across endpoints, identities, email, and cloud workloads, maintaining policy configuration and investigating Defender alerts
- Lead incident response activities following the NIST 800-61 lifecycle, coordinating containment, eradication, and recovery across technical and business stakeholders
- Conduct proactive threat hunting campaigns using MITRE ATT&CK framework, targeting adversary techniques relevant to the sector threat landscape
- Develop and maintain SOAR playbooks to automate repetitive incident and alert workflows, reducing mean time to respond
- Write and maintain Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection queries and analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel, aligned to current threat intelligence
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege access controls across the organisation
- Oversee Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies across the enterprise device estate

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Performed Tier 2 and Tier 3 SOC operations, triaging and investigating security alerts from CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel and driving incidents through the full response lifecycle
- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) to 8,000 users, delivering enterprise-wide Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and identity threat detection
- Conducted vulnerability scans using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus, prioritising findings against CVSS scores and remediation SLAs
- Monitored Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory for anomalous authentication patterns, privilege escalation, and Identity and Access Management (IAM) misconfigurations
- Delivered threat hunting investigations across endpoint and identity telemetry, using MITRE ATT&CK to structure and document findings
- Automated security workflows using PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel Logic App playbooks, reducing manual analyst workload

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Maintained security controls and endpoint protection across cloud and on-premises infrastructure in a Software as a Service (SaaS) environment
- Supported security monitoring and initial incident triage activities, documenting findings and escalating as required
- Contributed to infrastructure hardening and quality assurance initiatives, reducing the organisation's attack surface

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led enterprise-wide deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender to 8,000 users, delivering full Defender XDR coverage across endpoint, identity, and collaboration workloads
- Ran Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) campaigns that uncovered critical exposures in network segmentation and identity controls, enabling targeted remediation before adversary exploitation
- Designed SOAR automation playbooks that reduced mean time to triage for high-frequency alerts, releasing analyst capacity for complex Tier 3 investigations
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) across the organisation, enforcing least-privilege access and reducing the privileged attack surface
- Supported alignment to NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, and Cyber Essentials Plus through technical control implementation and ongoing operational assurance

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)